

FY2026 school budget — points for review

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To: Town Manager and Town Accountant, Town of Lunenburg **Generated:** 2026-09-03 by `scripts/build_discrepancy_review.py`

Comparing two documents for the school department, FY2026:

- **the YTD report** — the Town Accountant’s `FY26 BUDGET YEAR TO DATE REPORT (9-1-2026).xlsx`, sheet `ACCOUNT DETAIL`, column E
- **the school budget** — the district’s FY27 budget projection workbook, `FY26 FINAL BUDGET` column, sheet `FY27 Budget Projection`, column B

Both state amounts against the same function codes. **38 of 45 codes agree.**

Why this matters

Following a single line from what was budgeted to what was spent means finding it in both documents. Everything below is a case where that cannot be done, and each kind breaks it differently:

WHAT BREAKS	WHAT IT PREVENTS	SCALE
Codes do not match — 7 of 45 function codes hold different totals	Comparing a whole category. Guidance is \$753,939 in one document, \$384,910 in the other	\$4,579,195 · 17% of the appropriation
Lines do not match — one account against two budget lines	Attributing the money to a school, even when the total is right	\$1,896
One line, two amounts — one document before a transfer, one after	Knowing which figure is the budget	\$20,000
Spending with no budget — 6 accounts, nothing appropriated, no transfer	Tracing a charge to whatever authorised it	\$103,674
Zero budget, real spending — 4 accounts funded entirely by transfer	Reading the school budget as what a programme has	\$44,121
Transfers not named — approved 24 June 2026	Reconciling the year to what was voted	4 transfers

The consequence is the same in every case: **the year cannot be checked line by line** — not by a resident, not by the Finance Committee, and not by the district checking its own books against the Town’s.

No money is missing, and this is not an audit. Across both school departments the two documents reconcile to **\$1.93** in total. Every problem here is about where a figure sits and whether it can be found in both

places, not about how much there is.

Each item gives the account number and the school budget row, so it can be opened in both documents without searching. **Ordered by what needs an answer, not by size.** Where the archive cannot say which document is right it says so, and guesses are marked as guesses.

CATEGORY	ITEMS	SUM INVOLVED	WHAT IT NEEDS	IN THE MINUTES
A Spent without budget	6 accounts	\$103,674	How these were authorised	One contradicted, five silent
B Nothing appropriated, funded by transfer	4 accounts	\$44,121	What each transfer paid for	One voted, three silent
C Accounts not aligned	4 pairs of codes	\$550,708	Which code is authoritative	No vote on the coding itself
D Two figures on different bases	2 accounts	\$20,000	Which basis the school budget column uses	Voted, and explained
E Same total, different lines	1 code	\$1,896	Which line the money sits against	Partly voted

The sums are amounts involved, not money missing, and they do not add up.

A. Spent without budget

Nothing appropriated, no transfer in, and money paid out. 6 accounts, \$103,674.

YTD REPORT ACCOUNT	NAME	SPENT	IN THE SCHOOL BUDGET
0100-3-300-2330-03-2-12-1-511103	KINDAIDREG	\$93,691	code 2330 — 5 lines under it, none with an amount
0100-3-300-2330-03-2-13-1-511203	KINDPARREG	\$5,373	code 2330 — 5 lines under it, none with an amount
0100-3-300-2325-51-6-71-1-511003	HS SPED LT	\$1,500	code 2325 — 5 lines under it, none with an amount
0100-3-300-2415-51-4-05-2-555055	SPEDINSTRM	\$1,311	code 2415 — 10 lines under it, none with an amount
0100-3-300-2210-06-6-08-1-511019	SAL SCH ST	\$1,249	code 2210 — 7 lines under it, none with an amount
0100-3-300-2210-01-4-08-1-511102	ES CLERK/T	\$549	code 2210 — 7 lines under it, none with an amount

The two kindergarten accounts are \$99,064 of it. The FY26 approved budget published the kindergarten line as a cut, so the question is where these charges were provided for.

In the minutes.

Said on the record, and it does not fit — Finance Committee, 2026-01-12 (minutes)
“kindergarten classrooms were operating with 25 students and no aides”
Said by the School Committee Chair at a Tri-

Board meeting in January 2026, in the same year the ledger charges \$93,691 to KINDAIDREG and \$5,373 to KINDPARREG. Both statements can be true only if those accounts paid for something other than aides in kindergarten classrooms. Nothing in the archive settles which.

Requested, not a transfer — Finance Committee, 2026-02-26 (minutes)
“1 Kindergarten Paraprofessional: \$22,205”
Not a transfer and not a vote: an FY27 staffing INCREASE request, i.e. a position to be ADDED rather than one already running.

For the other four accounts: No vote in the archive names this account. The School Committee votes on line item transfers at almost every meeting, and several meetings record only that transfers were approved without saying which.

The school budget does carry a **Kindergarten Aides/Regular** line, row 333, printed at \$0, and a **Kindergarten Paraprofessionals** line, row 332, left blank.

B. Nothing appropriated, funded entirely by transfer

*The school budget appropriates **nothing** to these 4 accounts. Each was given money by transfer during the year. One is nearly all of it.*

YTD REPORT ACCOUNT	NAME	APPROPRIATED	MOVED	SPENT
0100-3-300-2710-06-6-65-1-511002	HS GUID SE	\$0	\$42,967	\$43,980
0100-3-300-2325-51-4-71-1-511003	ES LONG TE	\$0	\$600	\$0
0100-3-300-2420-04-4-62-2-555005	PHYS ED SU	\$0	\$550	\$527
0100-3-300-2420-06-6-63-2-555028	MUSIC BAND	\$0	\$4	\$0

In the minutes.

Voted and itemised — School Committee, 2025-09-17 (minutes)
“\$550 from the Elementary School art supply to the Elementary Phys Ed line”
Matches the \$550 moved into PHYS ED SU exactly.

The other three: No vote in the archive names this account. The School Committee votes on line item transfers at almost every meeting, and several meetings record only that transfers were approved without saying which.

C. Accounts not aligned

The same money under a different function code in each document. Both documents hold it; they disagree only about where it sits. The guess is mine, from the amounts, and is not established.

CODES	IN THE YTD REPORT	IN THE SCHOOL BUDGET	AMOUNT	MY GUESS
2710 vs 2900	0100-3-300-2710-04-4-65-1-511024; 0100-3-300-2710-05-5-65-1-511024; 0100-3-300-2710-06-6-65-1-511024; 0100-3-300-2710-07-2-65-1-511024	P.S. Social Worker row 364; E.S. Social Worker row 365; M.S Social Worker row 366; H.S. Social Worker row 367	\$369,029	Same money, filed two ways. Nothing missing
2310 ↔ 2320	0100-3-300-2310-51-0-06-1-511001 DWSPECIALI and 0100-3-300-2320-51-1- 06-1-511025 ACERESROOM	District Wide Specials (ELL) row 302 and ACE Special Ed Resource Rm Teacher row 298	\$90,219	One document has the two the wrong way round
0300 vs none	0100-3-300-0300-99-0-99-4-517006 SCHSALRESE	Salary Reserve, row 401 — under a section heading with no code	\$90,770	The same line
4230 vs 4220	0100-3-300-4230-07-2-32-2-525003 REP OFF MA	P.S. Repair Office Machines, row 196	\$690	The same line, coded two ways

The full code comparison, for anyone checking:

CODE	SCHOOL BUDGET GROUP	YTD REPORT	SCHOOL BUDGET	DIFFERENCE
2900	Social Worker Salaries	\$0	\$369,029	\$369,029
2710	Guidance Exp. / Guidance Salaries	\$753,939	\$384,910	\$369,028
0300	<i>no group under this code</i>	\$90,770	\$0	\$90,770
2320	Therapeutic Services	\$663,335	\$753,555	\$90,220
2310	Tutoring Cont. Ser. / Teachers Specialists - Special Education	\$2,187,067	\$2,096,848	\$90,219
4220	Maint. of Buildings	\$367,000	\$367,690	\$690
4230	M.S. Repairs / H.S. Repairs / Maintenance Repairs	\$57,145	\$56,455	\$690

In the minutes. No vote in the archive decides which coding is right for any of these four. The nearest thing is a March 2026 transfer that names one of the accounts as a source, without touching how it is coded:

Voted and itemised — School Committee, 2026-03-04 (minutes)
“A transfer of \$462.07 will be transferring from the supply line items, math, art, periodicals, library, guidance, repair office machines and general supplies to the Primary School special educations instructional material amount for testing supplies.”
Names REPAIR OFFICE MACHINES as a source, which is the account whose coding the two documents disagree about.

D. Two figures on different bases

Only accounts with a transfer can show which basis the school budget uses, because only there do the appropriation and the revised budget differ. There are 83 such accounts: the school budget matches the appropriation on 75, the revised budget on 1, and 7 cannot be told apart.

YTD REPORT ACCOUNT	APPROPRIATED	Moved	REVISED	SCHOOL BUDGET SAYS	SCHOOL BUDGET LINE
0100-3-300-3510-06-6-67-2- 535018 ATH INS	\$29,000	-\$20,000	\$9,000	\$9,000	Athletic Insurance, row 171
0100-3-300-3510-06-6-67-2- 535020 DUES/FEES	\$0	\$29,965	\$29,965	\$20,000	Athletic Dues & Fees, row 172

Insurance matches the revised figure rather than the appropriation; dues and fees matches neither. Which basis does the school budget column use, and for which lines?

In the minutes — this is the one item that is settled, and the district explained it itself.

Voted and itemised — School Committee, 2025-10-01 (minutes)
“We have one transfer it is to move \$20,000 from athletic insurance to athletic dues and fees, they were classified in the wrong object and org number”
Voted unanimously. The district states the reason itself: the original coding was wrong. This is the \$20,000 that makes the two documents differ.

So the \$20,000 is a transfer the School Committee approved on the record, for a reason it stated on the record. What is left is the narrower question of which figure the school budget column is meant to show, because it reflects this transfer and not the 75 others tested.

E. Same total, different lines

The code total agrees, so nothing is missing and no dollar is unaccounted for. The money sits against different lines inside the code — which is what happens when one account covers what the school budget splits across schools.

CODE	YTD REPORT	SCHOOL BUDGET
2415	0100-3-300-2415-51-5-05-2-555055 SPEDINSTRM \$1,896	E.S. Special Education Instr. Materials \$1,492, row 84; M.S. Special Education Instr. Materials \$404, row 97

In the minutes. A March 2026 vote moved \$462.07 into the Primary School special education instructional materials line, which is the same family of accounts — but it names the Primary School, not the two schools at issue here.

What the minutes do and do not record

Every transfer goes to a vote. Review & Approve Line Item Transfers, Warrants & Donations is a standing School Committee agenda item, and it appears at every meeting in FY26.

What the minutes then say varies. Some meetings itemise each transfer with both account names and the amount — the athletic insurance vote is a model of it. Others record only that transfers were approved. The clearest case is the last meeting of the year:

Voted, destinations not recorded — School Committee, 2026-06-24 (minutes)
“Mr. McNamara explains the four line item transfers for this meeting”
Approved unanimously at the last meeting of FY26.

The four are named nowhere in the archive, so any of the unexplained movements above could be among them.

Every FY26 meeting has now been read. The 5 November 2025 minutes were unreadable when this comparison was first made and have since been extracted; they record two transfers, both of which tie to the ledger exactly and neither of which touches anything in this document:

Voted and itemised — School Committee, 2025-11-05 (minutes)
“We want to transfer \$13,500 from admin tech contracts to school committee dues, to cover superintendent search invoice. Transfer \$2000 from school science supply line item at Primary School to the reading supply line item at the Primary school to cover cost.”
Both are in the ledger to the dollar: CONT SERV –\$13,500, SCI SUPP –\$2,000, READ SUPPL +\$2,000. Neither touches anything in this document — recorded here because these minutes were unreadable when this list was first compiled.

One referenced document is not in the archive. A March 2026 transfer of \$54,548.50 was made against a list of destinations that the minutes say was "provided to the committee (and available online)":

Voted, destinations not recorded — School Committee, 2026-03-04 (minutes)
“A transfer of \$54,548.50 to transfer funds to represent the new allocations for the SOA account, these funds will be going from instructional staff salaries”
The destinations are not in the minutes: they are "the list provided to the committee (and available online)". That list is not in this archive and is worth asking for.

What would close most of this in one step

The account master — the mapping from each MUNIS account number to its function code and description.

C and E answer themselves from it — those are the two where both documents hold the money and only the coding differs.

A, B and D need a word from somebody. A mapping cannot say how a charge was authorised against an account with no budget, say what a transfer paid for, or explain which basis a column is on.

And one document would help with all of it: the list of destinations behind the \$54,548.50 March transfer, which the minutes say was provided to the committee and is not in the public archive.

Method, in four lines

The join is the function code in the fourth segment of the MUNIS account string (0100-3-300-2330-51-2-13-1-511203), which is the same code the school budget prints over each group. Within a code, lines are paired **by amount**, which is not a key: it shows a figure of that size exists on both sides, never that the two are the same line. Full working in `sources/data/fy26-code-reconciliation.xlsx`.